

0.0.1 Vasettha

vāsetṭhasuttam

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Icchanangala in the Icchanangala Forest Grove. At that time many well-known wealthy brahmins were dwelling at Icchānangala, such as: the brahmin Canki, the brahmin Tarukkha, the brahmin Pokkharasati, the brahmin Janussoṇi, the brahmin Todeyya, and many other well-known and wealthy brahmins.

evam mesutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā icchānaṅgale paṭivasanti. seyyathidaṃ: caṅkī brāhmaṇo, tārukko brāhmaṇo, pokkharasāti brāhmaṇo, jānussoṇi brāhmaṇo, todeyyo brāhmaṇo, añño ca abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā.

2. Then brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this talk arose between them: “How indeed is one a brahmin?” The brahmin youth Bharadvaja said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is well borne, of pure descent from both the maternal and paternal sides as far back as seven generations, unblemished and irreproachable with regard to ancestry, it is to this extent, dear Sir,

that one is a brahmin.” The brahmin youth Vasettha said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is virtuous and excels in religious duties, it is to this extent, dear Sir, that one is a brahmin.”. Neither was the brahmin youth Bharadvaja able to convince the brahmin youth Vasettha, nor was the brahmin youth Vasettha able to convince the brahmin youth Bharadvaja.

atha kho vāseṭṭhabhāradvājānaṃ māṇavānaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamamānānaṃ anuvicaramānānaṃ¹ ayamantarā kathā udapādi: 'kathambho brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: yato kho bho ubhato sujāto hoti mātito ca pitito ca, saṃsuddhagahaṇiko yāva sattamā pitāmahayugā akkhitto anupakkuṭṭho jātivādena. ettāvatā kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. vāseṭṭho māṇavo evamāha: 'yato kho bho, sīlavā ca hoti vatasampanno² ca. ettāvatā kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. neva kho asakkhī bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ. na pana asakkhī vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ.

3. So then, brahmin youth Vasettha address the brahmin youth, Bharadvaja. Master Bharadvaja, there is this samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans who has gone forth from the Sakyan clan, dwelling at Icchanangala in the Icchanangala Forest Grove. Now a good repu-

¹ anucaṅkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ - machasaṃ, syā. ■

² vattasampanno - machasaṃ, sīmu, syā. ■

tation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” We must visit with the samana Gotama, O Master Bharadvaja. Upon arrival, we must ask the samana Gotama about this matter. In which ever way the samana Gotama will answer, in just that way we must bear it in mind.”

atha kho vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhāradvājaṃ māṇavaṃ āmantesi: 'ayaṃ kho bho bhāradvāja, samaṇo gotamo sakyaputto sakyakulā pabbajito icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. taṃ kho pana bhagavantam gotamaṃ evaṃ kalyāṇo kittisaddo abbhuggato: itipi so bhagavā araham sammasambuddho vijjācaraṇasampanno sugato loka-vidū anuttaro purisadammasārathī satthā devamanussānaṃ buddho bhagavā'ti. āyāma bho bhāradvāja, yena samaṇo gotamo tenupasaṅkamisāma. upasaṅkamitvā samaṇam gotamaṃ etamattaṃ pucchissāma. yathā no samaṇo gotamo byākarissati. tathā naṃ dhāressāmā'ti. evambhoti kho bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhassa māṇavassa paccassosi.

4. So then, the brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja visited with the Auspicious One. Having approached,

they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Vasettha addressed the Auspicious One in verse:

atha kho vāseṭṭha, bhāradvājā māṇavā yena bhagavā tenupasaṅkamim̐su. upasaṅkamtvā bhagavatā saddhiṃ sammodim̐su, sammodanīyaṃ kaṭhaṃ sārāṇiyaṃ vītisāretvā ekamantaṃ nisīdim̐su. ekamantaṃ nisinno kho vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhagavantaṃ gāthāhi ajjhabhāsi:

We are accepted and acknowledged,
as triple knowledge masters;
I am Pokkharasāti's student,
and this is Tārukka's student.

anuññātapatiññātā,
tevijjā mayamassu bho;
ahaṃ pokkharasātissa,
tārukkhassāyaṃ māṇavo.

Of the three knowledges which are declared,
there is perfection [by us];
from its etymology and grammar,
we are equal to our teachers in recitation.

tevijjānaṃ yadakkhātāṃ,
tattha kevalino'smase;

padakasmā veyyākaraṇā³,
jappe ācariyasādisā.

For us in regard to ancestry,
there is a dispute, O Gotama;
one is a brahmin by birth,
Bharadvaja speaks thus;
but I say by kamma,
know thus, O One Endowed with Eyes.

tesaṃ no jātivādasmiṃ,
vivādo atthi gotama;
jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,
bhāradvajo iti bhāṣati;
ahañca kammanā brūmi,
evaṃ jānāhi cakkhuma.

We are both unable,
to convince one another;
we have come to question the Auspicious One,

the Awakened One renowned as such.

te na sakkoma ñāpetuṃ,
aññamaññaṃ mayaṃ ubho;
bhagavantam puṭṭumāgamma⁴,
sambuddham iti vissutaṃ.

³no byākaraṇā - sīmu

⁴puṭṭhumāgamā - machasaṃ; puṭṭhum āgamma - syā

As the newly formed waxing moon,
 people worship with hands in anjali;
 they paying homage to the moon,
 so in the world is Gotama;
 the eye arisen in the world,
 we ask you Gotama.

candaṃ yathā khayātītaṃ,
 pecca pañjalikā janā;
 candaṃānā namassanti,
 evaṃ lokasmiṃ gotamaṃ;
 cakkhuṃ loke samuppannaṃ,
 mayaṃ pucchāma gotamaṃ.

Is one a brahmin by birth,
 or by kamma;
 tell us, we who do not know,
 how we may know a brahmin.

jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,
 udāhu bhavati kammanā;
 ajānataṃ no pabrūhi,
 yathā jānemu brāhmaṇanti.

For you, I will distinguish,
 one and the other because of their species;
 the analysis of birth of living beings,
 in sequence as it truly is.

tesaṃ vohaṃ vyācikkhissaṃ⁵ (vāsetṭhāti
bhagavā),
anupubbaṃ yathātathaṃ;
jātivibhaṅgaṃ pāṇānaṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

Know that the grass and trees,
even though [their birth] is not acknowledged;

their characteristics are made from birth,
one and the other because of their species.

tiṇarukkhepi jānātha,
na cāpi paṭijānare;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesaṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

Next the moths and grasshoppers,
up to the biting insects and ants;
their characteristics are made from birth,
one and the other because of their species.

tato kīṭe paṭaṅge ca,
yāva kunthakipillike;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesaṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

Know the four footed too,
among the small and the large;

⁵vo ahaṃ byakkhissaṃ - machasaṃ ■

their characteristics are made from birth,
one and the other because of their species.

catuppadepi jānātha,
khuddake ca mahallake;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

Know those that crawl with their stomachs
too,
serpents, long backed crawlers;
their characteristics are made from birth,
one and the other because of their species.

pādūdarepi jānātha,
urage dīghapitṭhike⁶;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

Next know from the fishes in water too,
with water as their pasture;
their characteristics are made from birth,
one and the other because of their species.

tato macchepi jānātha,
udake vārigocare;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

⁶dighapitṭhake - sīma. ■

Next know from the birds too,
 with wings as vehicles, going by the sky;
 their characteristics are made from birth,
 one and the other because of their species.

tato pakkhīpi jānātha,
 pattayāne vihaṅgame;
 liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ tesam,
 aññamaññā hī jātiyo.

As among these species,
 there are various characteristics made from
 birth;
 these various characteristics made from birth,
 do not exist among humans.

yathā etāsu jātīsu,
 liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ puthu;
 evaṃ natthi manusse,
 liṅgaṃ jātamayaṃ puthu.

Neither by head hairs nor by head,
 neither by ear nor by eyes;
 neither by face nor by nose,
 neither by mouth nor by eyebrows.

na kesehi na sīsehi,
 na kaṇṇehi na akkhīhi;
 na mukhena na nāsāya,
 na oṭṭhehi bhamuhi vā.

Neither by neck nor by shoulder,
 neither by stomach nor by back;
 neither by waist nor by breast,
 neither by genitals nor by mating.

na gīvāya na aṃsehi,
 na udarena na piṭṭiyā;
 na soṇiyā na urasā,
 na sambādhena methune.

Neither by hands nor by feet,
 neither by fingers nor by nails;
 neither by calf nor by thigh,
 neither by color nor by voice;
 certainly there are no characteristics made
 from birth,
 as in the case of other species.

na hatthehi na pādehi,
 nāṅgulīhi nakhehi vā;
 na jaṅghāhi na ūruhi,
 na vaṇṇena sareṇa vā;
 liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ neva,
 yathā aññāsu jātisu.

But among the bodies of individuals,
 this [difference] among humans is not to be
 found;
 but characteristics among humans,
 are for the sake of designation, it is said.

paccattaṃ ca sarīresu,
manussesvetam na vijjati;
vokārañca manussesu,
samaññāya pavuccati.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on cow-keeping;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a farmer, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
gorakkham upajīvati;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
kassako so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on the various kind of
crafts;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a craftsman, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
puthusinghena jīvati;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
sippiko so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on trade;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a merchant, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
 vohāraṃ upajīvati;
 evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
 vāṇijo so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
 lives in dependence on serving others;
 know him thus, O Vasettha,
 he is a servant, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
 parapessena jīvati;
 evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi
 pessiko so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
 lives in dependence on what is not given;
 know him thus, O Vasettha,
 he is a thief, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci munussesu,
 adinnaṃ upajīvati;
 evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
 corō eso na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
 lives in dependence on shooting arrows;
 know him thus, O Vasettha,
 he is a soldier, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
 issattham upajīvati;
 evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
 yodhājivo na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
 lives in dependence on the office of chief priest;

know him thus, O Vasettha,
 he is a sacrificing priest, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
 porohiccena jīvati;
 evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
 yājako so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
 enjoys [the revenue] from the nation and its
 villages;

know him thus, O Vasettha,
 he is a king, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
 gāmaṃ raṭṭhañca bhuñjati;
 evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
 rājā eso na brāhmaṇo.

But I do not call him a brahmin,
 born of a womb, begotten from a mother;
 he is called a sir-sayer,

if he owns something;
 owning nothing, a disowner,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

na cāhaṃ brāhmaṇaṃ brūmi,
 yonijaṃ mattisambhavaṃ;
 bhovādi nāma so hoti,
 sace hoti sakiñcano;
 akiñcanaṃ anādānaṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who, having cut all fetters,
 is truly not perturbed;
 who is detached with all bonds surmounted,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

sabbasaññojanaṃ chetvā,
 yo ve na paritassati;
 saṅgātiṃ visaññuttaṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who having cut delight and the thong,
 the tether together with the reins;
 the awakened one who has raised the cross
 bar,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

chetvā nandiṃ varattañca,
 sandānaṃ sahanukkamaṃ;
 ukkhittapaḷighaṃ buddhaṃ,

tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who is not offended but forbears,
abusive speech, beating and binding;
the powerful one with the strength of patience,

it is him I call a brahmin.

akkosaṃ vadhābandhañca,
aduṭṭho yo titikkhati;
khantibalaṃ balāṇikaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

The one endowed with conduct, not inclined
to anger,
endowed with virtue, not arrogant;
tamed, bearing his final body,
it is him I call a brahmin.

akkodhanaṃ vatavantaṃ,
sīlavantaṃ anussadaṃ;
dantaṃ antimasārīraṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

Like water on lotus leaf,
like mustard seed on a needle tip;
who is not smeared in sensual pleasures,
it is him I call a brahmin.

vāri pokkharapatteva,

āraggeriva sāsapo;
 yo na lippati⁷ kāmesu,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who wisely understands suffering,
 has extincted it right here by himself;
 who has put down the burden, detached,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

yo dukkhassa pajānāti,
 idheva khayamattano;
 pannabhāraṃ viṣaṃyuttaṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

The wise one with deep wisdom,
 the expert of the path and the non-path;
 one attained to the supreme goal,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

gambhīrapaññaṃ medhāviṃ,
 maggāmaggassa kovidāṃ;
 uttamattamanuppattaṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who mixes neither with householders,
 nor homeless ones alike;
 roaming without abode, with fewness of wishes,

it is him I call a brahmin.

⁷limpati - sīmu, machasaṃ, syā ■

asaṃsaṭṭhaṃ gahaṭṭhehi,
 anāgārehi cubhayaṃ;
 anokasāriṃ appicchaṃ,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

Having layed aside the rod among living beings,
 both the frail and the firm;
 who neither kills nor cause to kill,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

nidhāya daṇḍanaṃ bhūtesu,
 tasesu thāvaresu ca;
 yo na hanti na ghāteti,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

unobstructed among those obstructed,
 extinguished in the taking up of sticks;
 a disowner among owners,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

aviruddhaṃ viruddhesu,
 attadaṇḍesu nibbutaṃ;
 sādānesu anādānaṃ,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

For whom lust and hate,
 conceit and denigration are laid down;
 like mustard seed on a needle tip,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

yassa rāgo ca doso ca,
māno makkho ca ohito;
sāsaporiva āraggā,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who utters truthful words,
not harsh, conveying the meaning;
who does not abuse anyone,
it is him I call a brahmin.

akakkasaṃ viññāpaniṃ⁸,
giraṃ saccaṃ udīraye;
yāya nābhisaje⁹ kiñci,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who does not take what is not given in the
world,
whether long or short;
small or big, beautiful or ugly;
it is him I call a brahmin.

yo ca dīghaṃ ca rassaṃ vā,
aṇuṃ thūlaṃ subhāsubhaṃ;
loke adinnaṃ nādiyati¹⁰,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

For whom hope is not to be found,

⁸viññāpaniṃ - sīmu, machasaṃ, syā

⁹nābhisajje - machasaṃ, syā

¹⁰nādeti - machasaṃ, syā

in this world and in the other;
hopeless and detached,
it is him I call a brahmin.

āsā yassa na vijjanti,
asmiṃ loke paramhi ca;
nirāsayaṃ¹¹ viṣaṃyuttaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

For whom reliance is not to be found,
having known, without perplexity;
attained to firm footing in the deathless,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yassālayā navijjanti,
aññāya akathaṅkathī¹²;
amatogadhaṃ anuppattaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who here merit and demerit,
attachment to both he has overcome;
sorrowless, stainless, pure,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yodha puññaṅca pāpaṅca,
ubhosaṅgaṃ upaccagā;
asokaṃ virajaṃ suddhaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

¹¹nirāsāsaṃ - machasaṃ, syā

¹²akataṅkathī - sīmu.

Like the moon unblemished, pure,
clear and lucid;
with delight for being wholly extincted,
it is him I call a brahmin.

candaṃva vimalaṃ suddhaṃ,
vip̐pasannaṃaṃāvilāṃ;
nandībhavaṃparikkhīṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who has transcended this wandering on in
delusion,
an obstruction so hard to penetrate;
the meditator who has crossed and gone be-
yond,
unperturbed without perplexity;
without undertakings, fully quenched,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yo imaṃ paḷipathaṃ duggaṃ,
saṃsāraṃ mohaṃaccagā;
tiṇṇo pāragato jhāyī,
anejo akathaṅkathī;
anupādāya nibbuto,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who having abandoned sensual pleasures
here,
wanders about homeless;
with delight for sensual pleasures wholly ex-

tincted,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yodha kāme pahatvāna,
anāgāro paribbaje;
kāmaḥavaparikkhīṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who having abandoned thirsting here,
wanders about homeless;
thirsting in being wholly extincted,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yodha taṇhaṃ pahatvāna,
anāgāro paribbaje;
taṇhā bhavaparikkhīṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

Having abandoned the human bondage,
he has overcome the celestial bondage;
detached from all bondages,
it is him I call a brahmin.

hitvā mānusakam yogam,
dibbam yogam upaccagā;
sabbayogavisamyuttam,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

Having abandoned delight and discontent,
he has become cool, without ownership;

the hero who has conquered all the worlds,
it is him I call a brahmin.

hitvā ratiñca aratiṃ,
sītībhūtaṃ nirūpadhiṃ;
sabbālokābhibhūṃ vīraṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

He who knows death of beings,
and all their arisings;
unattached, well-fared, awakened,
it is him I call a brahmin.

cutiṃ yo vedi sattānaṃ,
upapattiñca sabbaso;
asattaṃ sugataṃ buddhaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

For he who devas, ghandhabbas and human
beings,
cannot understand his destiny;
The asava-free, the arahant,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yassa gatiṃ na jānanti,
devā gandhabbamānūsā;
khīṇāsavaṃ arahantaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

For he who after and before,

and in-between there is not something;
owning nothing, a disowner,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yassa pure ca pacchā ca,
majjhe ca natthi kiñcanam;
akiñcanam anādānam,
tamaham brūmi brāhmaṇam.

The chief bull, the most excellent hero,
the great seer, victorious;
the Buddha unperturbed, fully cleansed [with
the inner] bathing,
it is him I call a brahmin.

usabham pavaram vīram,
mahesiṃ vijitāvinam;
anejam nahātakam buddham,
tamaham brūmi brāhmaṇam.

He who knows his former abodes,
and sees the heavens and the lower worlds;
then attained to the extinction of birth,
it is him I call a brahmin.

pubbenivāsam yo vedi,
saggāpāyañca passati;
atho jātikkhayam patto,
tamaham brūmi brāhmaṇam.

Truly this is a designation in the world,
the assignment of name and clan;
arisen according to common usage,
it is assigned as so and so.

samaññā'hesā lokasmiṃ,
nāmagottaṃ pakappitaṃ;
samucca¹³ samudāgataṃ,
tattha tattha pakappitaṃ.

For a long time it has persisted,
those entrenched in views, not understanding;
from not understanding they declare to us,
one is a brahmin by birth.

dīgharattamanusayitaṃ,
diṭṭhigatamajānataṃ;
ajānantā¹⁴ no pabruvanti¹⁵,
jātiyā hoti brāhmaṇo.

Neither by birth is one a brahmin,
nor by birth is one not a brahmin;
by kamma is one a brahmin,
by kamma is one not a brahmin.

na jaccā brāhmaṇo¹⁶ hoti,

¹³sammuccā - sīmu. ■

¹⁴jānantā - sīmu. ■

¹⁵pabrunti - machasam ■

¹⁶vasalo - syā ■

na jaccā hoti abrāhmaṇo¹⁷;
 kammanā brāhmaṇo¹⁸ hoti,
 kammanā hoti abrāhmaṇo

By kamma is one a farmer,
 by kamma is one a craftsman;
 by kamma is one a merchant,
 by kamma is one a servant.

kassako kammanā hoti,
 sippiko hoti kammanā;
 vāṇijo kammanā hoti,
 pessiko hoti kammanā.

A thief too, one comes to be by kamma,
 by kamma is one also a soldier;
 by kamma is one a sacrificing priest,
 a king too, one comes to be by kamma.

coropi kammanā hoti,
 yodhājīvopi kammanā;
 yājako kammanā hoti,
 rājāpi hoti kammanā.

The wise ones see kamma,
 in just this way as it has come to be;
 the seers of dependent origination,
 experts in the results of kamma.

¹⁷pabrunti - machasam ■

¹⁸vasalo - syā ■

evametam yathābhūtam,
 kammaṃ passanti paṇḍitā;
 paṭiccasamuppādadasā,
 kammavipākakovidā.

By kamma the world keeps rolling,
 by kamma the generations turn;
 beings are bound by kamma,
 like the linchpin of a travelling chariot.

kammanā vattati loko,
 kammanā vattati pajā;
 kammanibandhanā sattā,
 rathassāṇīva yāyato.

By ardency in the life of purity,
 by self-control and taming;
 by this one is a brahmin,
 this is the brahmin unsurpassed.

tapena brahmacariyena,
 saṃyamena damena ca;
 etena brāhmaṇo hoti,
 etaṃ brāhmaṇamuttamaṃ.

Endowed with the triple knowledges,
 the peaceful one with renewal of being ex-
 tincted;
 know him thus, O Vasettha,
 as Brahma, the capable one who understands

discriminately.

tīhi vijjāhi sampanno,
santo khīṇapunabbhavo;
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
brahmā sakko vijānatanti.

5. When thus was said, the young brahmins Vasettha and Bharadvaja said this to the Auspicious One: “Excellent, O Bhante! Excellent, O Bhante! Just as, O Bhante, one might set upright what has been overturned, or open up what has been closed, or show a path to one who is lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so has the Dhamma been explained by the venerable Gotama in countless ways. We go, O Bhante, to the Auspicious Gotama, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Sangha of bhikkhus. May Master Gotama bear it in mind, that we are lay disciples who have gone for refuge from today for as long as life lasts.”

evaṃ vutte vāsetṭhabhāradvājā māṇavā bhagavantam etadavocum: abhikkantaṃ bho gotama, abhikkantaṃ bho gotama, seyyathāpi bho gotama, nikkujjitaṃ vā ukkujjeyya, paṭicchannaṃ vā vivareyya, mūlhasa vā maggaṃ ācikkheyya, andhakāre vā telapajjotaṃ dhāreyya, cakkhumanto rūpāni dakkhinti'ti. evamevaṃ bhotā gotamena anekapariyāyena dhammo pakāsito, ete mayaṃ bhavantaṃ gotamaṃ saraṇaṃ gacchāma, dham-

mañca bhikkhusaṅghañca. upāsake no bhavaṃ
gotamo dhāretu ajjatagge pāṇupetaṃ saraṇaṃ
gateti.

